Alexander Dovnar

DevOps & Cloud Architect

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SUMMARY

DevOps & Cloud Architect with 15 years in infrastructure, 10 of them building scalable, secure platforms on AWS, Oracle Cloud (OCI), Azure, and GCP. Deep expertise in Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Terragrunt, Helm), Kubernetes, CI/CD, and observability. Equally effective as a hands-on engineer and a technical lead — designing cloud architectures, launching 10+ production systems end-to-end, optimizing cost, and mentoring engineers. Actively applies AI to engineering — coding agents, MCP integrations, and agentic workflows. Co-author of "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025).

SKILLS

Cloud: AWS (expert), Azure, GCP, Oracle Cloud, Yandex Cloud, VK Cloud

IaC & Automation: Terraform / OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, Ansible, Packer, Vault

Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Travis CI

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, VictoriaMetrics, OpenSearch, OpenTelemetry

Security & FinOps: IAM hardening, secrets management, SBOM / supply-chain controls, cost optimization

AI Engineering: AI-assisted development with coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot); building & integrating MCP servers; agentic workflow design & LLM-driven automation

Scripting: Python, Bash

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer — Naviteq Ltd

Feb 2026 – Present

- Lead technology for a DevOps and cloud services company with 50+ engineers; the Head of DevOps and team leads report through me.
- Own technical pre-sales and solution architecture: high-level designs and estimations for cloud migrations and platform builds on AWS and Oracle Cloud (OCI).
- Technical lead for AWS-to-OCI migrations; an OCI assessment for an ad-tech client projected a 55% cut in non-production cloud spend.
- Stay hands-on: design and build the company's internal infrastructure platform (Terraform/OpenTofu modules, Helm charts, reusable CI/CD workflows).

Head of DevOps — Naviteq Ltd

Apr 2024 – Jan 2026

- Ran the DevOps practice of ~30 engineers through team leads: staffing across client projects, hiring, performance and career growth.
- Owned engineering standards and architecture review across client projects; stayed hands-on as tech lead on the largest engagements.
- Designed the observability migration from Prometheus to VictoriaMetrics for a global cybersecurity vendor's SASE platform: ~20,000 gateways across ~60 production regions.
- Replaced a multi-day take-home assignment with a one-hour live technical interview; started and ran the internal tech-talk program (23 sessions).

DevOps Team Lead — Naviteq Ltd

Dec 2021 – Mar 2024

- One of the company's first engineers. Led a team of 10 DevOps engineers: hiring, onboarding, 1:1s, performance reviews and day-to-day technical direction.
- Tech lead on the company's key client projects; delivered 10+ projects end-to-end, from architecture design to production.
- Built a cloud-agnostic Kubernetes platform from scratch for a security startup.
- Moved EKS clusters from Cluster Autoscaler to Karpenter, raising node utilization from ~70% to 90%+.
- Architected highly available, secure AWS infrastructure with cost optimization (saved up to 40%); standardized reusable Terraform/Terragrunt templates and CI/CD pipelines across teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer — OneSoil

Aug 2021 – May 2022 (consulting)

- Designed a multi-account AWS architecture and built a Kubernetes platform with Prometheus/Grafana observability.
- Reduced cloud costs by ~30% with no loss of performance.

Lead System Engineer — EPAM Systems

Apr 2016 – Aug 2021

- Grew from junior to lead engineer over five years.
- Designed AWS infrastructure and automated it with Terraform and Ansible; built CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins.
- Led the team as tech lead: planned work, assigned tasks, and reviewed solutions.
- Migrated enterprise systems to AWS and Azure on international fintech and retail projects.

Senior Network Engineer — RUE Beltelecom

Mar 2011 – Apr 2016

- Maintained the backbone network and corporate clients (VPN, Ethernet, SHDSL); automated network equipment maintenance with custom scripts.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Kubestronaut (CNCF, 2025), all five certifications active: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD), KCNA, KCSA
- Earlier: AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023–2026), AWS Certified Security – Specialty (2022–2025), HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate, Cisco CCNA

COMMUNITY & PUBLIC ACTIVITY

- Co-author, "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025, 560 pages; with Viktor Vedmich and Viktoria Semaan)
- Speaker: DevOpsDays Kazakhstan 2024 (talk and workshop), AWS Community Day Almaty 2025 (EKS cost-optimization workshop), DKT Conf 2026 (co-organizer and speaker)
- DevOps Kitchen Talks — co-host (2020–present); 100+ episodes, 300k+ views
- AWS Community Builder (2021–present); Terragrunt Ambassador (2025–present)
- Slurm.io — author & trainer for DevOps/SRE courses (CI/CD, Kubernetes, Terraform)

LANGUAGES

- English (fluent), Russian (native)

EDUCATION

- Engineer's degree, Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics (BSUIR), 2015